

Sentence Types

Sentence Structure

Simple Sentences

Simple sentences have just one clause.
They may have additional **phrases**.

Example

I went to the park to eat a hamburger.

Kyle, Keith, and Doug, my best friend from middle school, went to the playhouse and watched Shakespeare's *Hamlet*.

Coordinating Conjunctions

F.A.N.B.O.Y.S.

For

And

Nor

But

Or

Yet

So

Compound Sentence

Two or more clauses joined with a coordinating conjunction.

Using commas between clauses is **optional**.

Example

I went home **so** I could get some sleep.

Doug did his math work but he got some wrong, yet he didn't mind.

Subordinating Conjunctions

Most common subordinators

After	Now that	When
Although	Once	Whenever
As	Since	Where
Because	That	Wherever
Before	Though	While
Even if	Unless	
If	Until	

Complex Sentences

Two or more clauses joined with a subordinating conjunction.

If you begin a sentence with a subordinating conjunction, there **MUST** be a comma after the first clause.

Unless you want trouble, you should stop.
You should stop because I'm getting mad.

Compound-Complex Sentences

Has an **independent** clause and at least **two dependent** clauses, one of which is joined with a **coordinating** conjunction and one with a **subordinating** conjunction.

Examples

Because I paid attention, I got an A on the test and I was so happy.

I went home because it was getting late, but I had to wait on the porch until my mom got home anyway.

Practice

1. Read and analyze each sentence.
2. Determine whether the sentence is simple, compound, complex, or compound-complex.
3. Write your answer.

1

The weather has been nice but it may snow again any day.

2

Ever since the big blowout, she and I
haven't gotten along.

3

Dad brought candy because he felt bad.

4

If you want to go on the trip, you should bring your signed permission slip and I'll collect it before we go.

5

I left before the fight started.

6

Candy rots your teeth and TV makes you lazy, but I still like them.

7

He will call your home unless you are passing.